

- Reporting – Keeps historical resource utilisation information
- Monitoring – Real-time monitoring
- Dynamic DNS – Multiple DNS clients are included
- DHCP and relay ready

Some examples:

- Security – Stunner, Snort, Tinc, Nmap, arptwatch
- Monitoring – iftop, ntopng, Softflowd, urlsnarf, darkstat, mailreport
- Networking – NetIO, nut, Avahi
- Routing – FRR, OLSRD, routed, OpenBGPD
- Services – Iperf, widentd, syslog-ng, bind, Acme, Inspector, Git, DNS-server

2. ClearOS

ClearOS is a CentOS based open source firewall that transforms your standard PC into a committed firewall and Internet server/gateway. ClearOS has three editions: ClearOS Business, ClearOS Home and ClearOS Community. The community edition is free for a lifetime but for the other two, you need to purchase a subscription. It is one of the best open source firewalls for small to mid-sized businesses (SMBs). It is a complete network solution and you can extend the functionality by installing the apps such as the bandwidth manager, DHCP server, DMZ, DNS server and more.

Features

- Firewall, networking and security
- Provides several levels of security
- Bandwidth QoS manager
- DMZ, 1-to-1 NAT and port forwarding
- At the protocol level, the peer-to-peer detection system lets you manage file sharing usage
- Intrusion detection and intrusion prevention systems
- Virtual private networking
- Web proxy and content filtering

3. IPFire

IPFire is built on top of Netfilter and is an open source distribution. IPFire was designed with both modularity and a high level of flexibility in mind. It can be used as a firewall, proxy server or VPN gateway. The IDS (intrusion detection system) is inbuilt, so attacks are detected and prevented from Day One. And with the help of Guardian (an optional add-on), you can implement automatic prevention.

Features

- Stateful packet inspection (SPI)
- Proxy server with content filter and caching functionality
- Intrusion detection system
- VPN via IPsec and OpenVPN
- DHCP server
- Caching name server

- Time server
- Wake-on-LAN (WOL)
- Dynamic DNS

4. OPNsense

OPNsense is an open source, easy-to-use and easy-to-build FreeBSD based firewall and routing platform. It includes most of the features available in expensive commercial firewalls, and more. OPNsense offers the rich feature set of commercial offerings with the benefits of open and verifiable sources.

Features

- Traffic shaper
- Captive portal
- Forward caching proxy
- Virtual private network
- High availability and hardware failover
- Intrusion detection and inline prevention
- Built-in reporting and monitoring tools
- Support for plugins
- DNS server and DNS forwarder
- DHCP server and relay

5. VyOS

VyOS is an open source network operating system based on Linux and includes multiple applications such as Quagga, ISC DHCPD, OpenVPN, StrongSwan and others, under a single management interface. It can be installed on any physical hardware, on a virtual machine or a cloud platform.

Features

- VLANs
- Static and dynamic routing
- Firewall rulesets for IPv4 and IPv6 traffic
- Tunnel interfaces
- PPPoE, GRE, IPIP, SIT, static L2TPv3, VXLAN
- VPN
- NAT
- DHCP and DHCPv6 server and relay
- NetFlow and sFlow
- Web proxy and URL filtering
- QoS policies (drop tail, fair queue, and others), traffic redirection
- VRRP, connection table synchronisation

6. Smoothwall

Smoothwall is a Linux distribution designed to be used as an open source firewall. It is configured via a Web based GUI and requires little or no knowledge of Linux to install and use it. Smoothwall Express supports LAN, DMZ, internal/external network firewalling, Web proxy for acceleration, traffic stats, etc. Shutting down or rebooting is possible directly through the Web interface.

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